

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Parts of Speech - Qualifying English Learner-v2 Semantic Successor

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Parts of Speech - Complete Qualifying English Learning Session

Identity: qualifying-english-01: learner-v2:g1 **Generation date:** 2026-09-06 **Approval:** false **Official syllabus anchor:** Usage and Vocabulary; prerequisite control of word classes, noun number/countability, pronouns, modifiers and verb form.

Canonical/local source	SHA-256 at generation
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\basic\01_Parts-of-Speech.md	dd821f96b383f9fcc9c441af24d7b633fd9156939b81e0a6cb25ba25dea63b46
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\00_Master-Framework.md	6d21958ce3d0da9107bd467ebfffb56f016d91a1ff5d873d3d2af31b1817d15
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md	80723c9ace35be70e1a38f623e6384269824ea68932a696ba97c6381690a9827
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\README.md	cb5fd830a1a1d8d346d37fde4f27ec00e901b478b37136772246abeaaf538a53
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\subject-wide-package\Qualifying-English_Practice-Solutions.md	9e04b1a14020cc7871448842f207b89d9c649293cab9fffd2ed7fb98118b7fb1

Verification references

- <https://upsc.gov.in/examinations/previous-question-papers>
- https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/grammar/subject_verb_agreement.html
- https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/punctuation/commas/index.html
- <https://dictionary.cambridge.org/grammar/british-grammar/collective-nouns>
- <https://www.merriam-webster.com/wordplay/singular-nonbinary-they>

The local official-paper evidence establishes recurring demands, not an official answer key. Public usage references were used to challenge absolutes and accepted-variation claims. The canonical repository owner remains the teaching source of truth.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Twelve-panel ASCII master flow

PANEL 01 - SENTENCE SKELETON	
Find the finite verb, subject, object or complement before naming word classes.	
PANEL 02 - FUNCTIONAL WORD CLASSES	
Classify noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, determiner, preposition and conjunction by use in context.	
PANEL 03 - COUNTABILITY	
Distinguish count, mass and count-shift meanings; use measure expressions where needed.	
PANEL 04 - NUMBER AND AGREEMENT CUES	
Handle irregular, zero, plural-only and apparently plural singular nouns.	
PANEL 05 - PRONOUN CASE	
Choose subject, object, possessive and reflexive forms by grammatical role.	
PANEL 06 - PRONOUN REFERENCE	
Give every pronoun one clear antecedent and repair ambiguity by recasting.	
PANEL 07 - RELATIVE CLAUSES	
Distinguish restrictive from non-restrictive meaning before choosing relative and punctuation.	
PANEL 08 - SINGULAR THEY	
Accept clear modern singular they while preserving verb and noun-number logic.	
PANEL 09 - ADJECTIVES AND ADVERBS	
Place modifiers beside their targets and distinguish form from function.	
PANEL 10 - COMPARISON	
Use valid comparative forms and compare like with like.	
PANEL 11 - VERB FORM AND TRANSITIVITY	
Choose principal parts and test object-taking capacity.	
PANEL 12 - EDITING AND TIMING	
Make the smallest valid correction, flag legitimate variation and verify meaning.	

Parts of Speech, Nouns and Pronouns - Core

1. Sentence map and word classes

Class	Main job	Test
Noun	names a person, thing, quality or event	can often take a determiner/plural
Pronoun	replaces or points to a noun phrase	must have clear reference and case
Verb	expresses action, state or occurrence	finite verb changes for tense/agreement
Adjective	modifies a noun/pronoun	<i>a careful officer; officers are careful</i>
Adverb	modifies a verb, adjective, adverb or clause	<i>very careful; spoke carefully</i>
Determiner	identifies/quantifies a noun	<i>the, this, each, many, my</i>
Preposition	relates a noun phrase to another unit	<i>in Delhi; depend on evidence</i>
Conjunction	joins units	<i>and, although, because</i>

2. Nouns: number and countability

Pattern	Safe use	Example
Singular count noun	needs a determiner	<i>a book; the proposal; my answer</i>
Plural count noun	takes <i>many/few/fewer</i>	<i>many books; fewer errors</i>
Uncountable/mass noun	no ordinary plural; takes <i>much/little/less</i>	<i>much information; little evidence</i>
Measure expression	makes an uncountable noun countable	<i>two pieces of advice; three items of equipment</i>
Count shift	meaning changes when a mass noun is counted	<i>paper</i> (material) / <i>a paper</i> (article); <i>experience</i> (knowledge) / <i>an experience</i> (event)

Do not infer that every noun is permanently countable or uncountable:

Uncountable meaning	Countable meaning
<i>Chicken is expensive</i> (meat)	<i>three chickens</i> (birds)
<i>I need paper</i> (material)	<i>submit a paper</i> (essay/article)
<i>There is little room</i> (space)	<i>book a room</i> (place)
<i>Experience matters</i> (knowledge)	<i>it was a frightening experience</i> (event)
<i>Light travels quickly</i> (illumination)	<i>switch on the lights</i> (lamps)

Irregular, zero and plural-only nouns

Type	Examples	Agreement/use
Irregular plural	child/children, man/men, woman/women, foot/feet, tooth/teeth, mouse/mice, person/people	plural verb: <i>Children are...</i>
Same singular/plural	sheep, deer, aircraft, species, series	context decides: <i>one species is; two species are</i>
Noun ending in -s, singular	news, mathematics, economics (subject), politics (subject)	usually singular: <i>Economics is...</i>
Plural-only	scissors, trousers, spectacles, clothes, cattle, police	plural verb: <i>The police are...; a pair of scissors is...</i>
Collective noun	committee, team, government, family, jury	singular when viewed as one unit; plural when members act separately. Keep verb and pronoun consistent: <i>The committee has submitted its report / The committee are divided in their views.</i>

People is normally plural; persons is restricted to formal/legal counting. Data is commonly plural in careful academic prose (*the data are*), but singular collective *data is* occurs in modern general prose. Follow the question's register and remain consistent.

3. Pronouns: case, reference and agreement

Case

Function	Forms
Subject	I, we, he, she, they, who
Object of verb/preposition	me, us, him, her, them, whom
Possessive determiner	my, our, his, her, their, whose
Independent possessive	mine, ours, his, hers, theirs
Reflexive/emphatic	myself, yourself, himself, herself, itself, ourselves, yourselves, themselves

Use object case after a verb or preposition: *The officer called Riya and me; between you and me; whom did you meet?* In a comparison, supply the missing verb when needed: *She is taller than I (am); They invited her more often than me* is common but can be ambiguous. Write the full clause in a formal answer.

Reflexives need a same-clause antecedent or emphatic use: *She blamed herself; the director himself signed it.* Not Please contact myself; use me.

Reference, relatives and singular they

1. A pronoun must identify one sensible antecedent. Rewrite **When Ravi met Mohan, he was upset as Ravi was upset when he met Mohan**.
2. who is for people as subject; whom is object in formal style; whose shows possession; which normally refers to things; that may introduce a restrictive clause for people or things.
3. **Restrictive (identifying):** no commas. **Candidates who arrive late may not enter.* **Non-restrictive (extra):** *commas and normally* who/which, *not* that. *My brother, who lives in Pune, is a doctor.** Punctuation depends on intended meaning; it cannot be scored without context.
4. each, every, either, neither, everyone, someone, nobody normally take a singular verb: *Every applicant is ready.* Singular **they/them/their** is accepted modern formal English when sex is unknown or irrelevant: *Each applicant must bring their admit card.* A fully explicit alternative is *Each applicant must bring his or her admit card* or plural recasting: *Applicants must bring their admit cards.* Do not mark a clear singular

they wrong merely for being singular.

4. Adjectives, determiners and adverbs

The usual adjective order is opinion -> size -> age -> shape -> colour -> origin -> material -> purpose -> noun: *a useful small old Indian wooden writing desk*. It is a preference, not a mechanical rule.

Point	Safe form
Comparison	<i>taller; more careful; the tallest; the most careful</i>
No double comparison	more wiser -> <i>wiser</i>
Comparison target	<i>prefer X to Y; senior/junior/superior/inferior to</i>
Correlative comparison	<i>the more carefully you read, the better you write</i>
only placement	<i>Only Riya objected</i> (nobody else); <i>Riya objected only to the fee</i> (nothing else)
Fewer/less	<i>fewer books; less water</i> . less than ten minutes is accepted for quantity/time.

Some adverbs have the same form as adjectives: *fast, hard, late, early, daily*. Hardly means "scarcely," not "with effort": *work hard; hardly work*.

5. Verbs: form and transitivity

Pattern	Principal parts	Meaning check
rise	rise, rose, risen	something goes up itself
raise	raise, raised, raised	someone/something lifts another thing
lie (recline)	lie, lay, lain	<i>The child lay down yesterday</i>
lay (put)	lay, laid, laid	takes object: <i>She laid the file down</i>
fall	fall, fell, fallen	no object in ordinary use
fell	fell, felled, felled	cut down: <i>fell a tree</i>

Only verbs with an object normally form a passive: *The committee approved the plan -> The plan was approved*. Do not force a passive from *arrive, sleep, occur, happen*.

6. Fast diagnostic

Correct each, name the error code, then check below.

1. The police **is** investigating the case.
2. She gave me two useful **advices**.
3. Between you and I, the plan is unsafe.
4. Every candidate should bring **his** identity card.
5. The report **that** was published yesterday, changed the debate.
6. We bought two **furniture** for the office.

Key: 1 *are* [AGR]; 2 *pieces of advice* [CNT]; 3 *me* [PRO-CASE]; 4 *their* is accepted, or recast/pluralise [PRO-AGR]; 5 remove commas if identifying, or use *which* with commas if extra information [REL]; 6 *pieces of furniture* [CNT]. Time: **6 minutes**. Record every missed code in the error log in basic/05.

Semantic-completeness closure - 2026-09-06

Literal syllabus, ownership and boundary

- **Syllabus demand:** Usage and Vocabulary; prerequisite control of word classes, noun number/countability, pronouns, modifiers and verb form.
- **Canonical ownership:** Owns functional word-class recognition, nouns, pronouns, adjective/adverb distinction, determiners as a class, verb forms and transitivity.
- **Cross-topic boundary:** Full agreement, tense, articles, prepositions and conjunction systems belong to Topic 02; correction procedure and transformations belong to Topic 05.

Complete learner and answer route

1. **Sentence skeleton:** Find the finite verb, subject, object or complement before naming word classes.
2. **Functional word classes:** Classify noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, determiner, preposition and conjunction by use in context.
3. **Countability:** Distinguish count, mass and count-shift meanings; use measure expressions where needed.
4. **Number and agreement cues:** Handle irregular, zero, plural-only and apparently plural singular nouns.
5. **Pronoun case:** Choose subject, object, possessive and reflexive forms by grammatical role.
6. **Pronoun reference:** Give every pronoun one clear antecedent and repair ambiguity by recasting.
7. **Relative clauses:** Distinguish restrictive from non-restrictive meaning before choosing relative and punctuation.
8. **Singular they:** Accept clear modern singular they while preserving verb and noun-number logic.
9. **Adjectives and adverbs:** Place modifiers beside their targets and distinguish form from function.
10. **Comparison:** Use valid comparative forms and compare like with like.
11. **Verb form and transitivity:** Choose principal parts and test object-taking capacity.
12. **Editing and timing:** Make the smallest valid correction, flag legitimate variation and verify meaning.

Authority, variation and hostile-query gate

Classify a word by its sentence function, preserve count meaning, identify the pronoun antecedent, distinguish accepted singular they, and test whether a verb has an object before passivising.

The review checked the local official UPSC compulsory-English papers listed in README .md, the repository's verbatim syllabus, the subject-wide solved package, and standard public usage references recorded in the learner successor. It explicitly stress-tested: **finite verb; countability; collective noun; pronoun case; antecedent; restrictive; singular they; transitivity.**

Prefer plain contemporary formal English. Where more than one standard form is legitimate, state the variation and select a conservative examination form only as a risk-control choice; do not falsely label the alternative ungrammatical.

Progressive practice and timed-paper transfer

1. Foundation: identify the demand and state the governing rule in plain language.
2. Controlled application: correct or construct one sentence and explain the change.
3. Passage/paragraph transfer: preserve meaning, reference, register and logical relation.
4. Hostile test: reject a close option that is grammatical in another meaning or variety.
5. Timed execution: answer, verify, classify the error, and retry a fresh item.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Diagnostic and core set

Q1. Foundation rule - word class: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Classify the word by its function in the sentence. B. Use its most common dictionary label regardless of context. C. Treat every -ly word as an adverb. D. Treat every word before a noun as an adjective.

Correct answer: A. Record can be a noun or verb; early can be adjective or adverb.

Q2. Foundation rule - count nouns: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A singular count noun can always stand bare. B. A singular count noun normally needs a determiner. C. Every abstract noun must take the. D. Plural nouns always need an article.

Correct answer: B. Institutional and fixed expressions are separate article questions.

Q3. Foundation rule - mass nouns: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add -s to every mass noun. B. Use many with all mass nouns. C. Use a measure phrase for a counted amount of advice, equipment or furniture. D. Treat news as plural because it ends in s.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q4. Foundation rule - count shift: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every noun is permanently countable or uncountable. B. A count shift is always informal. C. Mass nouns can never take an article. D. Countability can change with meaning, as in paper/a paper.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q5. Foundation rule - plural-only: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Police, cattle, trousers and scissors normally take plural agreement. B. All nouns ending in s are singular. C. A pair of scissors takes a plural verb. D. Police takes a singular verb in formal English.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q6. Foundation rule - collective nouns: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Collective nouns are always plural. B. Agreement may reflect the group as a unit or its members, but pronouns must remain consistent. C. Collective nouns are always singular in every standard variety. D. A singular verb may be followed by an unrelated plural pronoun.

Correct answer: B. British English permits plural notional agreement more freely.

Q7. Foundation rule - pronoun case: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use I after every occurrence of and. B. Use myself as a polite substitute for me. C. Use object case after a verb or preposition: between you and me. D. Use whom as the subject of a finite verb.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q8. Foundation rule - pronoun reference: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Choose the nearest noun even when illogical. B. Ambiguity is harmless in formal prose. C. Repeat he until the reader guesses the referent. D. Rewrite a pronoun if two plausible antecedents remain.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q9. Foundation rule - relative clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Restrictive clauses identify; non-restrictive clauses add removable information. B. All relative clauses take commas. C. That is preferred in every non-restrictive clause. D. Punctuation never changes relative-clause meaning.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q10. Foundation rule - singular they: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Singular they is always an agreement error. B. Clear singular they is accepted modern formal English. C. His is the only correct generic pronoun. D. Their must always refer to a plural noun.

Correct answer: B. A plural recast or his or her may also be used.

Q11. Foundation rule - comparison: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. More wiser is emphatic formal English. B. Senior is followed by than in standard usage. C. Compare like with like and avoid double comparatives. D. Less is required before every plural count noun.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q12. Foundation rule - transitivity: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every verb can be made passive. B. Happen takes a direct object. C. Arrive forms a normal personal passive. D. Only an object-taking use normally supplies an object for passive voice.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q13. Editing decision - word class: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Classify the word by its function in the sentence. B. Use its most common dictionary label regardless of context. C. Treat every -ly word as an adverb. D. Treat every word before a noun as an adjective.

Correct answer: A. Record can be a noun or verb; early can be adjective or adverb.

Q14. Editing decision - count nouns: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A singular count noun can always stand bare. B. A singular count noun normally needs a determiner. C. Every abstract noun must take the. D. Plural nouns always need an article.

Correct answer: B. Institutional and fixed expressions are separate article questions.

Q15. Editing decision - mass nouns: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add -s to every mass noun. B. Use many with all mass nouns. C. Use a measure phrase for a counted amount of advice, equipment or furniture. D. Treat news as plural because it ends in s.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q16. Editing decision - count shift: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every noun is permanently countable or uncountable. B. A count shift is always informal. C. Mass nouns can never take an article. D. Countability can change with meaning, as in paper/a paper.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Progressive transfer exercises with model answers

Transfer 1. Classify every underlined word in: "Those two careful officers spoke unusually calmly."

Model answer: Those-determiner; two-determiner/numeral; careful-adjective; officers-noun; spoke-verb; unusually-adverb; calmly-adverb.

Transfer 2. Correct: "The equipments were delivered, but one furniture was damaged."

Model answer: The equipment was delivered, but one piece of furniture was damaged.

Transfer 3. Remove ambiguity: "When Anita spoke to Kavita, she was anxious."

Model answer: State the intended referent, e.g. "Anita was anxious when she spoke to Kavita."

Transfer 4. Give both standard readings of "The committee has/have reached a decision."

Model answer: Singular presents the committee as one unit; plural presents members acting individually in British-style usage.

Transfer 5. Correct only if needed: "Every candidate should bring their admit card."

Model answer: No correction is required; singular their is accepted modern formal English. A plural recast is also safe.

Transfer 6. Explain why "The accident was happened yesterday" fails.

Model answer: Happen is intransitive in this use and has no object to promote into a passive subject.

Transfer 7. Distinguish "work hard" from "hardly work."

Model answer: Hard means with effort; hardly means scarcely.

Transfer 8. Timed edit: identify all functions in "After the meeting, the chair quickly recorded the final decision."

Model answer: After-preposition; meeting-noun; chair-noun; quickly-adverb; recorded-verb; final-adjective; decision-noun.

Remediation protocol

1. State the rule or passage evidence before looking at the options.
2. Explain why each close distractor fails in this context.
3. Record accepted variation separately from genuine error.
4. Rewrite one fresh sentence or paragraph using the same principle.
5. Advance only after two consecutive correct timed attempts.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified local official-paper demand ledger

Year	Local official paper	Demand routed to this topic	Provenance status
2018	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMP_00.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2019	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-EnglishCompulsory.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2020	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH (1).pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2021	books\more_previous_papers\English.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2022	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-ENGLISH-Comp1-280922.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2023	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-23-ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-290923.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2025	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-QP-CSM-25-010925.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required

This table records verified paper demand and format only. It does not reproduce copyrighted question wording, invent a UPSC key, or claim that UPSC publishes model answers.

Timed hostile set

Q33. Timed-paper choice - relative clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

- A. Restrictive clauses identify; non-restrictive clauses add removable information. B. All relative clauses take commas. C. That is preferred in every non-restrictive clause. D. Punctuation never changes relative-clause meaning.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q34. Timed-paper choice - singular they: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

- A. Singular they is always an agreement error. B. Clear singular they is accepted modern formal English. C. His is the only correct generic pronoun. D. Their must always refer to a plural noun.

Correct answer: B. A plural recast or his or her may also be used.

Q35. Timed-paper choice - comparison: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. More wiser is emphatic formal English. B. Senior is followed by than in standard usage. C. Compare like with like and avoid double comparatives. D. Less is required before every plural count noun.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q36. Timed-paper choice - transitivity: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every verb can be made passive. B. Happen takes a direct object. C. Arrive forms a normal personal passive. D. Only an object-taking use normally supplies an object for passive voice.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q37. Hostile variation check - word class: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Classify the word by its function in the sentence. B. Use its most common dictionary label regardless of context. C. Treat every -ly word as an adverb. D. Treat every word before a noun as an adjective.

Correct answer: A. Record can be a noun or verb; early can be adjective or adverb.

Q38. Hostile variation check - count nouns: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A singular count noun can always stand bare. B. A singular count noun normally needs a determiner. C. Every abstract noun must take the. D. Plural nouns always need an article.

Correct answer: B. Institutional and fixed expressions are separate article questions.

Q39. Hostile variation check - mass nouns: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add -s to every mass noun. B. Use many with all mass nouns. C. Use a measure phrase for a counted amount of advice, equipment or furniture. D. Treat news as plural because it ends in s.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q40. Hostile variation check - count shift: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every noun is permanently countable or uncountable. B. A count shift is always informal. C. Mass nouns can never take an article. D. Countability can change with meaning, as in paper/a paper.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Register-sensitive refinements

- Collective-noun agreement varies by whether the writer presents the group as a unit or its members; British usage permits plural agreement more freely than American usage.
- *Data* may be plural in technical prose and singular as a mass collective in general prose. Preserve the passage's register and consistency.
- Formal *whom* remains useful where the pronoun is clearly an object, but an answer should not manufacture an unnatural construction merely to display it.
- A word's dictionary category does not override its actual function: *before* can operate as preposition, conjunction or adverb.

Adversarial checks

Test noun-to-verb shifts, mass-to-count shifts, fused determiner/pronoun uses, ambiguous comparatives, non-human relative reference, reflexive misuse and intransitive verbs falsely converted to passive.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Rapid reconstruction spine

- **Sentence skeleton:** Find the finite verb, subject, object or complement before naming word classes.
- **Functional word classes:** Classify noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, determiner, preposition and conjunction by use in context.
- **Countability:** Distinguish count, mass and count-shift meanings; use measure expressions where needed.
- **Number and agreement cues:** Handle irregular, zero, plural-only and apparently plural singular nouns.
- **Pronoun case:** Choose subject, object, possessive and reflexive forms by grammatical role.
- **Pronoun reference:** Give every pronoun one clear antecedent and repair ambiguity by recasting.
- **Relative clauses:** Distinguish restrictive from non-restrictive meaning before choosing relative and punctuation.
- **Singular they:** Accept clear modern singular they while preserving verb and noun-number logic.
- **Adjectives and adverbs:** Place modifiers beside their targets and distinguish form from function.
- **Comparison:** Use valid comparative forms and compare like with like.
- **Verb form and transitivity:** Choose principal parts and test object-taking capacity.
- **Editing and timing:** Make the smallest valid correction, flag legitimate variation and verify meaning.

Ownership, variation and answer firewall

- **Own here:** Owns functional word-class recognition, nouns, pronouns, adjective/adverb distinction, determiners as a class, verb forms and transitivity.
- **Route elsewhere:** Full agreement, tense, articles, prepositions and conjunction systems belong to Topic 02; correction procedure and transformations belong to Topic 05.
- **Verification rule:** Classify a word by its sentence function, preserve count meaning, identify the pronoun antecedent, distinguish accepted singular they, and test whether a verb has an object before passivising.
- Prefer the smallest defensible correction; preserve meaning and label accepted variants.
- In passage work, cite the text. In precis, add nothing. In essays, invent no quotation or statistic.

Timed-paper spine

READ DEMAND -> MAP STRUCTURE -> APPLY RULE -> CHECK MEANING -> FLAG VARIATION -> REVISE